

THE BUILD GUIDE

Chandu

MOMOS

— Small-batch Himalayan momos

HOW TO BUILD A CINEMATIC SCROLL- DRIVEN FOOD WEBSITE

- 01 — AI image generation
- 02 — AI video generation
- 03 — Claude Code
- 04 — Live website



4-6 HRS
TOTAL TIME

18 STEPS
START TO FINISH

1 LIVE SITE
THE RESULT

By **Dhiraj Sarkar** · AutomationX

[YouTube](#) [Instagram](#) [Skool](#)

Inside this guide

This is the exact system behind the Chandu Momos website — from the first AI image to a live, scroll-driven site. Follow the steps in order. Every prompt is copy-paste ready.

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Stuck on a step?

Post in the community — someone has hit it before.

[YOUTUBE](#)[INSTAGRAM](#)[FREE COMMUNITY](#)[AUTOMATIONX PRO](#)

What you're building

Chandu Momos is a small-batch dumpling brand. Its website is one long page where nothing just loads and sits there — everything reacts to scroll.

“Scrolling is the play button.”



01

Hero film

A cinematic film scrubs forward and back as you move the mouse wheel.

02

Flavour orbit

A full-screen showcase rotates through four flavours as you scroll.

03

Craft sequence

Four process photos cross-fade in perfect sync with scroll.

WORKS FOR ANY BRAND

Tea, coffee, skincare, chocolate, perfume, jewellery — only the product, copy and palette change. The mechanics you learn here are the reusable system.

THE FULL PIPELINE

- 01 Generate 6 hero “story” images that form one continuous narrative
- 02 Generate 4 transparent flavour plates — the product shots
- 03 Generate 3 craft-process cutouts: fold, steam, sear
- 04 Generate 3 atmosphere photos and 2 garnish cutouts
- 05 Turn the story images into one smooth, scroll-ready hero film
- 06 Generate 3 short ambient films for the big moments
- 07 Set up a project folder with a tiny local preview server
- 08 Hand one master prompt to your AI coding tool
- 09 Iterate like a client, not a programmer
- 10 Deploy to Netlify or Vercel

Your toolkit

Six tools. Most are free, and any AI coding tool with folder access will do the job.

AI image generator 01

Product photos, story stills and transparent cutouts.

USED HERE

Runway MCP (nano-banana-pro). OpenAI image generation for one atmospheric shot.

AI video generator 02

Turns stills into motion and short ambient loops.

USED HERE

Runway MCP (seedance-2) · 4s clips · 1080p · no audio.

AI coding tool 03

Turns your assets + one prompt into the actual website.

USED HERE

Claude Code. Antigravity, Codex, Cursor and Windsurf work the same — they just need folder access.

ffmpeg 04

Compresses video, prepares it for scroll-scrubbing, grabs poster frames.

USED HERE

Free, command line, Mac / Windows / Linux.

Node.js 05

Runs a tiny local preview server.

USED HERE

Any recent version (18+).

Netlify / Vercel 06

Hosts the finished static site.

USED HERE

Both free. Netlify: drag-and-drop or GitHub. Vercel: import from GitHub.

NEW TO THE TERMINAL?

You only need to copy-paste four short ffmpeg commands. They're all collected on the cheat sheet (page 26).

Choose your concept

Before generating a single image, answer five questions on paper. Every visual decision downstream comes from these answers.

PRODUCT

+

EMOTION

+

RITUAL

+

ENVIRONMENT

+

TRANSFORMATION

CHANDU MOMOS'S ANSWERS

ELEMENT

ANSWER

Product

Small-batch, hand-folded Himalayan-style momos (dumplings)

Emotion

Warmth, steam, home — being fed by someone who cares

Ritual

Folding the dough, dropping it in boiling water, sharing one plate with many hands

Environment

Warm amber studio light on a soft caramel-brown backdrop; later, a dark green editorial home

Transformation

Raw dumpling → filling exposed → into the pot → cooked → plated → shared

STRONG ENOUGH?

- ✓ It breaks naturally into 5–6 visual chapters
- ✓ One element physically transforms
- ✓ The feeling is specific — “steam and warmth passed hand to hand,” not just “tasty food”

YOUR TURN

PRODUCT

EMOTION

RITUAL

ENVIRONMENT

TRANSFORMATION

Plan the full asset list

Write the whole shot list before you generate anything. This site was built from 20 files, grouped by role.

CATEGORY	COUNT	PURPOSE
Hero story stills	6	Keyframes for the scroll-scrubbed hero film — one continuous story
Hero film	1	Merged + re-encoded; the scrolling background of the hero
Flavour plates	4	Transparent product shots for the rotating showcase
Craft cutouts	3	Transparent fold → steam → sear sequence
Atmosphere photos	3	Story section, shared-table section, footer
Garnish cutouts	2	Small floating decorations in the showcase
Ambient films	3	Heat poster, kitchen, footer
Poster stills	1 per film	Extracted (not generated) — shown before a video loads

NAMING RULES

lowercase

hyphens only

a leading role word

no spaces

no “final2”

✓ GOOD

image-3-dumplings-enter-water.png
stage-steam.webp
film-chilli-pour.mp4

✗ AVOID

IMG_4821.png
final2 NEW (1).png
Untitled video.mp4

Why it matters: your AI coding tool reads filenames to understand what each asset is for. The full file list appears as a folder tree in Step 10.

Generate the hero story images

Six images, one continuous story. Generate them in order, uploading each finished image as the reference for the next — that keeps lighting, backdrop and framing identical.

① RAW — ② FILLING — ③ FALLING — ④ COOKING — ⑤ PLATED — ⑥ SHARED

KEEP IN EVERY PROMPT

warm amber spotlight from above, soft caramel-brown gradient backdrop, ultra photorealistic, macro food photography, shallow depth of field, no text, no watermark

01 RAW, SEALED DUMPLING

image-1-dumpling-raw.png

Reference: none — first image

A single raw, sealed dumpling floating in the exact center of the frame, delicate hand-pleated dough crimp visible along the top seam, warm amber spotlight from directly above, soft caramel-brown gradient background fading to dark at the edges, subtle soft shadow beneath, floating with no plate, no surface, no hands, ultra photorealistic macro food photography, shallow depth of field, no text, no watermark.

02 FILLING EXPOSED, INGREDIENTS ORBITING

image-2-ingredients-orbiting.png

Reference: image-1

The same dumpling now torn open in the center of frame revealing the seasoned meat and herb filling inside, raw ingredients orbiting around it in suspended motion — a few pieces of chopped scallion, fresh coriander leaves, small clusters of minced meat, and cracked pepper — all floating mid-air as if caught the instant they were tossed, same warm amber spotlight, same caramel-brown gradient background, ultra photorealistic macro food photography, no text, no watermark.

03 FALLING TOWARD THE BOILING POT

image-3-dumplings-enter-water.png

Reference: image-2

The same open dumpling now falling through the air toward a glass pot of boiling water below, the orbiting scallion, coriander and pepper still trailing around it mid-fall, visible steam and water droplets rising from the rolling boil beneath, glass pot with visible handles catching the same warm amber light, camera holding the same locked framing, ultra photorealistic macro food photography, no text, no watermark.

Hero story images, continued

04 COOKING, FULLY SUBMERGED

Reference: *image-3*

image-4-dumplings-cooked.png

A cluster of dumplings now fully submerged and cooking inside the same glass pot of boiling water, wide shot pulled back to show the pot's rim and handles, thick steam rising off the rolling water into the warm amber light, a few coriander leaves floating on the surface between the dumplings, same caramel-brown gradient background, ultra photorealistic macro food photography, no text, no watermark.

05 PLATED AND STEAMING

Reference: *image-4*

image-5-plated-dumplings.png

A generous bowl of the same dumplings, now cooked, glistening and lightly garnished with fresh herbs, arranged in a shallow ceramic bowl, thick steam rising off the top, warm amber spotlight from above, same soft caramel-brown gradient background, ultra photorealistic editorial food photography, shallow depth of field, no text, no watermark.

06 SHARED AT THE TABLE

Reference: *image-5*

image-6-family-hands-table.png

The same bowl of dumplings now resting on a warm wooden table, several hands reaching in from different sides — one steadying the bowl, one holding a spoon serving into it, others resting nearby — soft warm ambient light replacing the studio spotlight, a blurred vase and plant visible in the background, intimate close, editorial and unposed, no faces in sharp focus, ultra photorealistic, no text, no watermark.

WHY THIS ORDER MATTERS

Each image changes only **one** thing from the one before it — filling exposed, then falling, then submerged, then plated, then shared. That's what lets Step 7 turn them into one seamless morphing film instead of six disconnected clips.



1 · RAW



2 · FILLING



3 · FALLING



4 · COOKING



5 · PLATED



6 · SHARED

Generate the product plates

Four flavours, shot overhead on plain white so they can be cut out later (Step 9). Same walnut plate, same dip bowl, same lighting — only the dumplings, sauce and garnish change.



01

CLASSIC CHICKEN

Generate this one first

chicken-plate.webp

Top-down overhead shot of ten seared, golden-browned dumplings arranged in a circle on a round dark walnut wooden plate, a small white dipping bowl in the center filled with a dark soy-sesame dipping sauce topped with fresh coriander leaves and sesame seeds, a scattering of julienned carrot and coriander to one side, studio overhead lighting, sharp focus, editorial food photography, plain white background, no hands, no text, no watermark.



02

MALAI PANEER

Reference: chicken-plate

paneer-plate.webp

Top-down overhead shot of ten golden-browned dumplings arranged in a circle on the same round dark walnut wooden plate, a small white dipping bowl in the center filled with a pale creamy green herb-yoghurt dip topped with a coriander sprig and a dusting of spice, same studio overhead lighting, sharp focus, editorial food photography, plain white background, no hands, no text, no watermark.



03

FARM FRESH VEG

Reference: chicken-plate

veg-plate.webp

Top-down overhead shot of ten golden-browned dumplings arranged in a circle on the same round dark walnut wooden plate, a small white dipping bowl in the center filled with a vivid green herb chutney topped with a coriander sprig and sesame seeds, julienned carrot garnish to one side, same studio overhead lighting, sharp focus, editorial food photography, plain white background, no hands, no text, no watermark.



04

FIERY CHILLI GARLIC

Reference: chicken-plate

spicy-plate.webp

Top-down overhead shot of ten golden-browned dumplings arranged in a circle on the same round dark walnut wooden plate, a small white dipping bowl in the center filled with a glossy red chilli-garlic sauce topped with a coriander sprig, dried red chilli flakes and julienned carrot scattered across the plate, same studio overhead lighting, sharp focus, editorial food photography, plain white background, no hands, no text, no watermark.

Generate the craft-process cutouts

Three images showing how momos are made, in order. Each gets cut out and floats on the page with a soft drop shadow — no card, no box.



01 **FOLD**



02 **STEAM**



03 **SEAR**

01 FOLD

stage-fold.webp

Six raw, hand-pleated dumplings arranged on a flour-dusted wooden paddle board, one dumpling in the foreground torn open to reveal the raw seasoned filling inside, visible flour dusting on the board, soft natural side light, shallow depth of field, editorial food photography, plain white background so it can be cut out cleanly, no hands, no text, no watermark.

02 STEAM

stage-steam.webp

A round bamboo steamer basket, lid tilted open, filled with pleated dumplings, thick visible steam rising off the dumplings inside, warm natural light, editorial food photography, plain white background so it can be cut out cleanly, no hands, no text, no watermark.

03 SEAR

stage-sear.webp

A dark cast-iron skillet with a handle, filled with dumplings pan-seared to a deep golden-brown crust on the bottom, scattered sesame seeds and sliced spring onion across the top, warm directional light catching the sear marks, editorial food photography, plain white background so it can be cut out cleanly, no hands, no text, no watermark.

ON THE WEBSITE

These three cross-fade in sync with scroll. Keep the camera angle and light similar across all three so the fade reads as one process, not three photos.

Atmosphere photos & garnishes

Three photos set the emotional beats of the quiet sections. Two tiny cutouts decorate the showcase — generate them on white, cut out afterwards.



ATMOSPHERE

01 STORY / MANIFESTO

[manifesto-feast-v2.webp](#)

A photorealistic luxury food-editorial wide banner showing one complete dark ceramic bowl of silky steamed and lightly seared dumplings beside a small dish of chilli chutney. Dark textured wood, deep forest-green interior, warm amber sidelight, subtle natural steam. Place the entire bowl in the center-right with generous dark negative space for HTML copy on the left. No text, logos, people, floating ingredients or cropped food. An original scene.

02 SHARED TABLE

[table-shared.webp](#)

Overhead photorealistic shot of a dark wooden table at night lit by a single warm overhead lamp, several hands and forearms in soft sweaters reaching in from every side of frame, wooden chopsticks resting beside each place, a large central plate of steamed dumplings with a small bowl of red dipping sauce, smaller side plates of dumplings at each seat, warm intimate cinematic lighting, no faces in sharp focus, no text, no watermark.

03 FOOTER

[footer-feast.webp](#)

A candlelit night scene, two people in warm hooded jackets seated at a rustic wooden table lit only by small glass candle jars and an oil lamp, reaching in with wooden chopsticks toward a large metal tray piled with dumplings — half golden pan-seared, half pale steamed — steam rising, deep green foliage and stone wall softly lit in the background, intimate documentary mood, cinematic and warm, no text, no watermark.

GARNISHES

04 CHILLI GARNISH

[garnish-chili.webp](#)

A small cluster of dried red chilli flakes and toasted sesame seeds beside one halved fresh red chilli, scattered naturally, overhead studio lighting, plain white background so it can be cut out cleanly, no text, no watermark.

05 HERB GARNISH

[garnish-herbs.webp](#)

A single fresh coriander sprig beside a small scattered pile of sliced spring onion rounds, overhead studio lighting, plain white background so it can be cut out cleanly, no text, no watermark.

Build the hero scroll film

The hero video never plays on its own — scrolling moves it frame by frame. That only feels smooth if the film is short, continuous, and re-encoded so every frame is a keyframe.

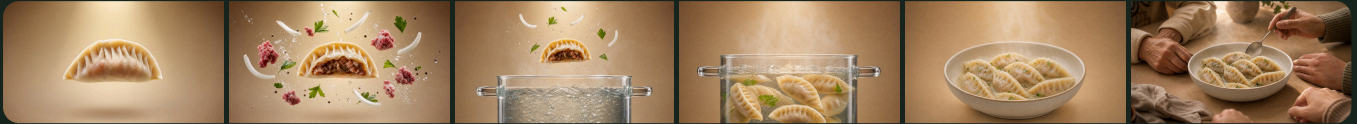


image-1

image-2

image-3

image-4

image-5

image-6

A · ONE CLIP PER IMAGE PAIR

CLIP	START	END	LENGTH
Raw → filling exposed	image-1	image-2	2s
Filling → falling into pot	image-2	image-3	2.5s
Falling → cooking	image-3	image-4	2s
Cooking → plated	image-4	image-5	2.5s
Plated → shared at table	image-5	image-6	3s

CLIP PROMPT Ultra slow-motion seamless transformation between the two reference images, warm amber spotlight, soft caramel-brown gradient background, camera completely locked with zero movement, cinematic photorealistic macro food footage, no text, no watermark.

If a clip drifts off-look, add: "Ultra realistic luxury food-editorial commercial, warm studio lighting throughout, no CGI glow, no text, no watermark."

B · MERGE WITH HARD CUTS ONLY

Drop all five clips into any editor (Canva, CapCut, Premiere) in order. **No fades, no dissolves** — each clip ends where the next begins, so a hard cut is invisible. Export as `hero-story-raw.mp4`.

C · RE-ENCODE FOR SMOOTH SCRUBBING

TERMINAL

BASH

```
ffmpeg -i hero-story-raw.mp4 \  
-vf scale=1280:-2 -movflags faststart \  
-vcodec libx264 -crf 20 -g 1 -pix_fmt yuv420p \  
-acodec aac -b:a 128k \  
assets/dumpling-story-scrub.mp4
```

`-g 1` makes every frame a keyframe, so the browser can jump to any exact frame as you scroll — without it, scrubbing stutters. `-crf 20` keeps the hero sharp.

Generate the ambient films

Three 4-second loops for the loud moments — heat poster, kitchen and footer. No audio needed.

01 HEAT POSTER — CHILLI OIL POUR

film-chilli-pour.mp4

A slow-motion 4-second loop of glossy red chilli oil being poured in a thin ribbon over a plate of golden pan-seared dumplings, steam rising, dried chilli flakes and sesame seeds visible on the surface, dramatic warm spotlight against a near-black background, camera locked, cinematic and appetite-driving, no people, no text, no audio needed, seamless loop if possible.

02 KITCHEN — LEVITATING DISH

film-levitation.mp4

A slow-motion 4-second loop of a plate of dumplings gently rotating and levitating in mid-air against a dark backdrop, soft steam trailing beneath it, warm rim light catching the edges, dreamlike and elegant, camera locked, cinematic, no people, no text, no audio needed, seamless loop if possible.

03 FOOTER — RISING STEAM

film-steam.mp4

A slow-motion 4-second loop of thick steam rising and curling off a bowl of dumplings just out of frame, warm backlighting turning the steam golden, dark background, cinematic and intimate, camera locked, no people, no text, no audio needed, seamless loop if possible.



COMPRESS EVERY FILM

BASH

```
ffmpeg -i raw-film.mp4 -vf scale=1280:-2 \
  -crf 30 -an -movflags +faststart output.mp4
```

Took these films from ~3MB to 228–438KB. **-an** drops audio; **+faststart** lets playback begin early.

EXTRACT A POSTER FRAME

BASH

```
ffmpeg -i film-steam.mp4 -vframes 1 \
  assets/film-steam-poster.webp
```

The browser shows this still while the video loads — so visitors never see an empty grey box.

Get real transparency

Most AI image tools don't return a truly transparent background. You get a checkerboard painted into the pixels — it looks fine in preview, then shows up as grey squares on your page.

RECOMMENDED

The easy way

- 1 Generate on a plain white background — already written into every prompt in this guide.
- 2 Run each image through a one-click remover: **Photoroom**, **remove.bg**, Adobe's tool, or Runway / Magnific's built-in background removal.
- 3 Export as `.webp` with transparency.

ADVANCED

The script way

Only if a one-click tool keeps eating part of your subject. Ask your AI coding tool to write a script that:

- 1 Marks pixels as background if they're near-grey (max - min channel $\leq \sim 14$) within a brightness band.
- 2 Flood-fills inward from the image border only — so a white bowl surrounded by food is never touched.
- 3 Runs a second pass for small enclosed grey pockets.
- 4 Feathers the edge with a light blur, then crops to content.

TWO GOTCHAS

Don't sample checker colours from a corner patch — a corner can sit entirely inside one square. Classify by greyscale + brightness instead.

The checkerboard isn't always light. A dark checker (black + `~#5f5f5f`) needs the brightness floor dropped to 0.

ALWAYS VERIFY

Place each cutout on a **solid colour** and look for leftover grey patches. Never check on a checkerboard — a leftover checker is invisible against another checkerboard.



GENERATED ON WHITE



CHECKED ON SOLID ✓

Set up the project folder

One folder, one assets subfolder, and a tiny server so you can preview the site on your own machine.

PROJECT STRUCTURE

```
chandu-momos/
├── index.html           ← your AI tool builds this
├── dev-server.mjs       ← local preview server
└── assets/
    ├── dumpling-story-scrub.mp4
    ├── film-chilli-pour.mp4
    ├── film-levitation.mp4
    ├── film-steam.mp4
    ├── film-steam-poster.webp
    ├── chicken-plate.webp
    ├── paneer-plate.webp
    ├── veg-plate.webp
    ├── spicy-plate.webp
    ├── stage-fold.webp
    ├── stage-steam.webp
    ├── stage-sear.webp
    ├── manifesto-feast-v2.webp
    ├── table-shared.webp
    ├── footer-feast.webp
    ├── garnish-chili.webp
    └── garnish-herbs.webp
```

01

CREATE THE FOLDER

Put every finished asset from Steps 3–9 inside **assets/**, named exactly as shown.

02

ADD DEV-SERVER.MJS

A plain file server can't "seek" inside a video — and scroll-scrubbing needs exactly that. This ~40-line server handles it (full code on the next page).

03

RUN IT

Open a terminal in the folder and run `node dev-server.mjs`, then open **localhost:4174**.

04

LEAVE IT RUNNING

Refresh the browser after every change your AI coding tool makes.

A PEEK INSIDE ASSETS/



chicken-plate.webp



paneer-plate.webp



veg-plate.webp



spicy-plate.webp



stage-fold.webp



stage-steam.webp



stage-sear.webp



garnish-chili.webp

dev-server.mjs

Don't want to type it? Ask your AI coding tool: "Create dev-server.mjs with this exact code." The key part is byte-range support — it lets the browser jump anywhere inside a video.

DEV-SERVER.MJS

JAVASCRIPT

```
import { createServer } from 'node:http';
import { createReadStream, statSync } from 'node:fs';
import { extname, join, normalize, sep } from 'node:path';

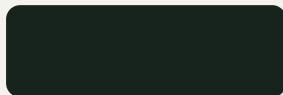
const root = process.cwd();
const port = Number(process.env.PORT || 4174);
const types = {
  '.html': 'text/html; charset=utf-8', '.css': 'text/css; charset=utf-8',
  '.js': 'text/javascript; charset=utf-8', '.jpg': 'image/jpeg',
  '.jpeg': 'image/jpeg', '.png': 'image/png', '.webp': 'image/webp',
  '.mp4': 'video/mp4'
};

createServer((request, response) => {
  const pathname = decodeURIComponent(new URL(request.url, 'http://localhost').pathname);
  const relative = normalize(pathname).replace(/^[\/\\]+/, '') || 'index.html';
  const target = join(root, relative);
  if (target !== root && !target.startsWith(root + sep)) {
    response.writeHead(403).end(); return;
  }
  let stats;
  try { stats = statSync(target); if (!stats.isFile()) throw new Error('Not a file'); }
  catch { response.writeHead(404).end(); return; }
  const headers = {
    'Content-Type': types[extname(target).toLowerCase()] || 'application/octet-stream',
    'Accept-Ranges': 'bytes',
    'Cache-Control': 'no-cache, no-store, must-revalidate'
  };
  const range = request.headers.range?.match(/^bytes=(\d*)-(\d*)$/);
  if (range) {
    const start = range[1] ? Number(range[1]) : 0;
    const end = range[2] ? Number(range[2]) : stats.size - 1;
    if (start > end || end ≥ stats.size) {
      response.writeHead(416, { 'Content-Range': 'bytes */' + stats.size }).end(); return;
    }
    response.writeHead(206, { ...headers,
      'Content-Range': 'bytes ' + start + '-' + end + '/' + stats.size,
      'Content-Length': end - start + 1 });
    if (request.method === 'HEAD') response.end();
    else createReadStream(target, { start, end }).pipe(response);
    return;
  }
  response.writeHead(200, { ...headers, 'Content-Length': stats.size });
  if (request.method === 'HEAD') response.end();
  else createReadStream(target).pipe(response);
}).listen(port, '127.0.0.1', () =>
  process.stdout.write('Preview: http://localhost:' + port + '\n'));
```

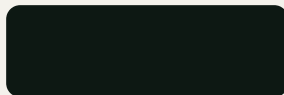
The design system

Every colour lives in one CSS variable, so the whole site re-themes by changing a single line each. Use these as a starting point — pick your own for your brand.

GREENS



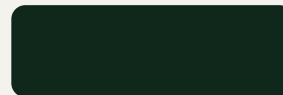
`--night`
`#17241d`
Primary dark background



`--deep`
`#0d1813`
Darkest anchor

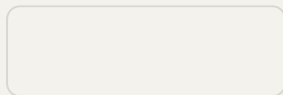


`--pine`
`#263d31`
Secondary green

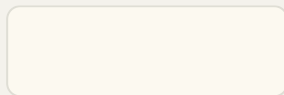


`--story-green`
`#10271c`
Story tableau

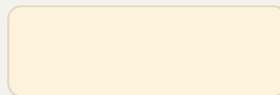
LIGHTS



`--paper`
`#f4f2ec`
Light sections



`--chalk`
`#fcf9f0`
Warm off-white



`--butter`
`#fdf3dc`
Cream on red

TEXT



`--ink`
`#19231d`
Body on light



`--muted`
`#58645a`
Secondary text

ACCENTS



`--sun`
`#d9b77e`
Gold — buttons, kickers



`--ember`
`#cf4a2f`
“The heat”



`--chilli`
`#b5231a`
Craft / poster



`--chilli-deep`
`#7c140d`
Deep red anchor

THREE FONTS, THREE ROLES

Aa

Cormorant Garamond

EDITORIAL VOICE

Hero, manifesto, table, collection, footer

AA

Bebas Neue / Antonio

APPETITE VOICE

High-energy poster moments

Aa

Plus Jakarta Sans

BODY VOICE

All body copy, everywhere

THE RULE

Use display fonts **by role, not at random**: narrative sections stay in the serif, high-energy poster moments use the bold face. Pick your own pairing — keep the discipline.

Site architecture

A luxury scroll site is a sequence of chapters, each with one job. This is the final running order of Chandu Momos.

- | | | |
|----|-------------|---|
| 01 | Hero | <i>Scroll-scrubbed film. Nothing autoplays — scrolling is the play button.</i> |
| 02 | Manifesto | <i>One atmospheric photo, one emotional line, a button into the menu.</i> |
| 03 | Dish orbit | <i>Pinned, full-screen. Scroll rotates through all four flavours.</i> |
| 04 | Heat poster | <i>One striking film, one bold headline, minimal copy.</i> |
| 05 | The table | <i>A calm photographic beat — one image, a human quote, a small spec strip.</i> |
| 06 | Craft | <i>Fold → steam → sear cutouts cross-fade in sync with scroll.</i> |
| 07 | Order menu | <i>Real pricing and direct WhatsApp order links.</i> |
| 08 | Wholesale | <i>A second call-to-action for a different buyer.</i> |
| 09 | Kitchen | <i>Ambient film behind a short statement.</i> |
| 10 | Footer | <i>Brand, a second atmosphere photo, contact links, copyright.</i> |

TRANSITIONS

Every section change on the live site has its own signature animation — a curtain, an aperture, bamboo slats. **Don't start there.** Ship plain scroll reveals first; add signature transitions once the core site works.



The motion engine

Lenis smooths the scroll, GSAP ScrollTrigger drives animation, and the hero film is scrubbed directly. You won't type this — the master prompt asks for it — but knowing what it does helps you give better feedback.

CDN IMPORTS · EXACT VERSIONS

HTML

```
<script defer src="https://cdnjs.cloudflare.com/ajax/libs/gsap/3.12.5/gsap.min.js"></script>
<script defer src="https://cdnjs.cloudflare.com/ajax/libs/gsap/3.12.5/ScrollTrigger.min.js"></script>
<script defer src="https://unpkg.com/lenis@1.3.23/dist/lenis.min.js"></script>
```

LENIS + GSAP SYNC

JS

```
const lenis = window.Lenis ? new Lenis({ lerp: .08, smoothWheel: true, wheelMultiplier: .9, anchors: false }) : null;
if (lenis) {
  lenis.on('scroll', ScrollTrigger.update);
  gsap.ticker.add(tick);
  gsap.ticker.lagSmoothing(0);
}
function tick(time) { lenis.raf(time * 1000); }
```

HERO VIDEO SCRUB

JS

```
const film = document.getElementById('source-video');
let ticking = false, duration = 0, initialized = false;
const clamp = (v, lo, hi) => Math.min(Math.max(v, lo), hi);

function updateFilm() {
  if (!initialized || !duration) return;
  const total = track.offsetHeight - window.innerHeight;
  const passed = clamp(-track.getBoundingClientRect().top, 0, total);
  const value = total > 0 ? passed / total : 0;
  if (film.readyState ≥ 2) film.currentTime = clamp(value * duration, 0, duration);
}

function requestTick() {
  if (ticking) return;
  ticking = true;
  requestAnimationFrame(() => { updateFilm(); ticking = false; });
}

function initScrub() {
  duration = film.duration;
  if (!duration || !Number.isFinite(duration)) return;
  film.pause(); film.currentTime = 0; initialized = true;
  window.addEventListener('scroll', requestTick, { passive: true });
  window.addEventListener('resize', requestTick);
  if (lenis) lenis.on('scroll', requestTick);
  requestTick();
}

if (film.readyState ≥ 2) initScrub();
else {
  film.addEventListener('loadedmetadata', initScrub, { once: true });
  film.addEventListener('loadeddata', initScrub, { once: true });
  film.load();
}
```

No canvas, no frame sequence. Scroll position (from `getBoundingClientRect`, never `scrollY` alone) sets the video's `currentTime` directly.

Smoothstep, not linear. The craft cross-fade uses $b^3(3-2b)$, so photos never linger at a 50/50 “double exposure”.

The master build prompt

Open your AI coding tool, point it at the project folder, confirm it can see /assets, then paste this in **one message**. Fill in the gold [BRACKETS] first.

MASTER PROMPT · PART 1 OF 2

PASTE AS ONE MESSAGE

Build a single-page, scroll-driven luxury website for [BRAND NAME], a [ONE-LINE DESCRIPTION OF THE BUSINESS].

TECH CONSTRAINTS:

- One self-contained index.html file – inline <style> and <script>, no build step, no framework, no npm packages beyond CDN <script> tags.
- GSAP 3.12.5 + ScrollTrigger plugin from cdnjs.
- Lenis 1.3.23 from unpkg, synced with GSAP ScrollTrigger (see reference code).
- Fonts via Google Fonts <link> tag.
- All media assets already exist in /assets – reference them by relative path, never invent placeholder images.
- html { overflow-x: clip } and body { overflow-x: clip } – NEVER overflow-x: hidden anywhere, it turns the element into a scroll container and silently breaks every ScrollTrigger measurement on the page.
- Scope smooth scrolling to html:not(.lenis) only – Lenis already smooths scrolling itself, and scroll-behavior:smooth left un-scoped fights ScrollTrigger's internal measurement jumps.
- Never put overflow:hidden on a section that contains a pinned/sticky child – put any needed clipping on an inner wrapper instead.
- Must work down to 375px phone width with no horizontal scroll.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion: static content instead of animation.

DESIGN SYSTEM:

- Every colour as a CSS custom property on :root.
- Three font-role variables: one editorial/serif voice for narrative sections, one bold poster/display voice for high-energy moments, one clean sans-serif for body copy. Use them by role, never at random.
- Palette direction: [DESCRIBE YOUR COLORS].
- Overall mood: [e.g. "warm, editorial, steam and candlelight – not a loud sales page"].

HERO SECTION (the core mechanic):

- A pinned, tall (e.g. 500-800vh) scroll track containing a <video> element.
- The video NEVER autoplays. Its currentTime is driven directly by scroll progress, measured with getBoundingClientRect() against the track – never window.scrolly alone. Use requestAnimationFrame + a 'ticking' flag to avoid redundant updates per scroll event.
- Text overlays fade in/out at specific scroll-progress ranges (e.g. 0.05-0.15, 0.4-0.5) – timed to specific visual beats in the video, never overlapping the brightest part of frame.
- A thin fixed progress bar on one screen edge that fills 0-100% with scroll.

Master prompt, continued

MASTER PROMPT · PART 2 OF 2

SAME MESSAGE

SECTIONS (in this order, adapt count/names to your brand):

1. Hero: scroll-scrubbed video as above.
2. Manifesto/story: one atmospheric photo with generous negative space for copy, a short emotional line, a CTA into the menu.
3. A pinned, full-viewport product showcase: scrolling rotates through N products, each with name/description/price. Dot indicator + counter (e.g. "01/04"). User cannot scroll past until every product has been shown. Include a floating product image the user can tilt in 3D by moving their mouse over it (perspective transform following cursor, eased not instant).
4. A full-bleed "impact" poster: one striking video/photo background, one bold headline, minimal copy.
5. A quiet photographic beat: one calm image, a short human quote, a small spec/stats strip.
6. A process/craft section: 3-4 process photos cross-fading in sync with scroll, using a smoothstep easing curve ($b*b*(3-2*b)$) rather than linear.
7. An order/menu section with real pricing and direct order links:
`https://wa.me/[YOUR NUMBER]?text=[URL-ENCODED PRE-FILLED MESSAGE]`
8. Optional: a second CTA section for a different buyer (wholesale/B2B/gift).
9. A footer: brand, a second atmospheric photo, contact links, copyright.

INTERACTIONS:

- The 3D-tilt product image from section 3.
- A click-to-expand modal with more product detail.
- Ambient floating-particle canvas effect in at least one section (subtle).
- Give the 2-3 biggest section transitions their own short, distinct signature animation instead of a plain scroll or fade.

PERFORMANCE:

- Background videos play only while visible (IntersectionObserver), and pause on visibilitychange (tab hidden).
- Every video needs a poster image so there's never an empty box while it loads.
- Keep total page weight reasonable – this is a marketing page, not an app.

Give me the whole site as one index.html, and tell me which files it expects inside /assets.

CHANGE PER BRAND

The [bracketed] parts · the section list · the palette
direction

KEEP AS WRITTEN

Tech constraints · design-system structure · hero-scrub
mechanic · performance rules

Iterate like a client, not a programmer

You won't get the finished site from one prompt — this one took many rounds of small, specific feedback. Here's the pattern that works.

01

Run it, look, don't guess.

Refresh localhost:4174 after every change and actually look before saying anything.

02

Point at exactly where.

Plain language beats vague. Paste screenshots — most AI coding tools can read them.

03

One judgement call at a time.

A font, a colour, a name. Confirm you like it before asking for the next thing.

04

Say “don't change anything else.”

A vague request invites the tool to “improve” things you never asked about.

05

Ask what happened before asking for a fix.

A good coding tool can explain the real cause (see Step 16) instead of patching the symptom.

SAY THIS

“The small text in the top-left of the flavour showcase is too faint.”

NOT THIS

“Fix the header.”

Hard-won bugs

Real ones from building this site. Each cost hours to diagnose — knowing them in advance saves you that time.

01 **overflow-x: hidden on <body> breaks every scroll animation.**

It turns body into its own scroll container, so ScrollTrigger measures against something that never scrolls. Animations fire in the wrong place — sometimes thousands of pixels off.

FIX overflow-x: clip on both html and body.

02 **scroll-behavior: smooth fights ScrollTrigger.**

ScrollTrigger jumps to the top to measure, then restores. Smooth scrolling animates that jump, so measurements come out wrong.

FIX Scope it to html:not(.lenis).

03 **overflow: hidden on a section kills pinning inside it.**

The pinned content silently stops pinning and just clips off.

FIX Put clipping on an inner wrapper, never the section with the pinned child.

04 **“Transparent” AI images usually aren’t.**

Covered in Step 9 — a checkerboard preview hides the exact problem.

FIX Verify every cutout on a solid colour.

05 **Background videos keep running off-screen.**

They burn CPU and battery for no visible benefit.

FIX IntersectionObserver to play/pause + a visibilitychange listener.

06 **A backgrounded preview can’t paint video.**

IntersectionObserver won’t fire either in that state.

FIX Check video by extracting frames with ffmpeg, not screenshots.

07 **Lenis fights a plain window.scrollTo.**

Programmatic jumps land in the wrong place.

FIX Call it in a short loop until it converges, or dispatch real wheel events.

Deploy

No build step — it's a plain static site. Push it to GitHub, then let Netlify or Vercel host it for free.

PUSH TO GITHUB

BASH

```
git init
echo "node_modules/" > .gitignore
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit - Chandu Momos"

# create a new repo on github.com, then:
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOU/chandu-momos.git
git branch -M main
git push -u origin main
```

PICK ONE HOST — BOTH ARE FREE

Netlify

Drag your folder into app.netlify.com/drop, or connect the GitHub repo.

Vercel

Go to vercel.com/new and import your GitHub repo. Preset: "Other".

01 No build command

Plain static HTML. The publish / output directory is the project root.

02 Skip heavy files

List raw sources in `.netlifyignore` or `.vercelignore` — e.g. the big raw hero video and `*.png` originals.

03 Auto-deploys

Once the repo is connected, every `git push` publishes a new version.

04 Big videos?

Use Git LFS: `git lfs track "*.mp4"` before committing.

Before you publish: check the name

A business name isn't automatically yours just because you built a site with it.

Copyright

Protects the creative work — your code, photos, copy. It does **not** protect a business name.

Trademark

Protects the name. An existing business with a similar name — especially in your category — can cause real problems.

Before launch: search your exact name plus "restaurant", "brand" or "trademark". Names tied to something invented or personal are easier to clear and stronger to own.

Same system, different brand

The mechanics never change — only the content, copy, palette and prompts. Here's the exact system mapped onto a specialty coffee roastery.

	CHANDU MOMOS	NORTH BLOOM COFFEE
HERO STORY	Raw dumpling → filling → boiling → cooked → plated → shared	Coffee cherry → pulped → drying → roasting drum → ground → poured
PRODUCTS	Chicken, Paneer, Veg, Chilli Garlic	Pour-Over, Cold Brew, Espresso, Oat Latte
CRAFT CUTOUTS	Fold → steam → sear	Green beans → roaster → grinding → pour
STORY PHOTO	Bowl on dark wood, space on the left	A single cup on a dark counter, steam rising
SHARED TABLE	Many hands, one shared plate	Two people at a café table, mid-conversation
AMBIENT FILMS	Chilli pour, levitating dish, steam	Pour over ice, levitating bean, espresso steam
PALETTE	Forest green · cream · gold · chilli red	Espresso brown · warm cream · copper
ORDERING	WhatsApp link, real pricing	Same pattern — new number and message
SHOWCASE	"Four Signature Flavours" orbit	"Four Signature Roasts" — same mechanic

You're not learning how to build a momo website — you're learning a reusable system for any photo-driven, product-led brand.

Quick-reference cheat sheet

Everything you'll copy more than once, on one page.

01 CONCEPT FORMULA

Product + Emotion + Ritual +
Environment + Transformation

02 NAMING RULE

lowercase + hyphens + role prefix
image-3-dumplings-enter-water.png

03 THE BUILD PIPELINE

Concept → Shot list → Image generation → Video generation →
Re-encode (-g 1 for the hero) → Organised /assets → Master prompt →
AI coding tool → Iterate → Deploy

04 HERO RE-ENCODE — EVERY FRAME A KEYFRAME

```
ffmpeg -i raw.mp4 -vf scale=1280:-2 -movflags faststart -vcodec libx264 \  
-crf 20 -g 1 -pix_fmt yuv420p -acodec aac -b:a 128k scrubbed.mp4
```

05 AMBIENT LOOP COMPRESSION

```
ffmpeg -i raw.mp4 -vf scale=1280:-2 \  
-crf 30 -an -movflags +faststart out.mp4
```

06 POSTER-FRAME EXTRACTION

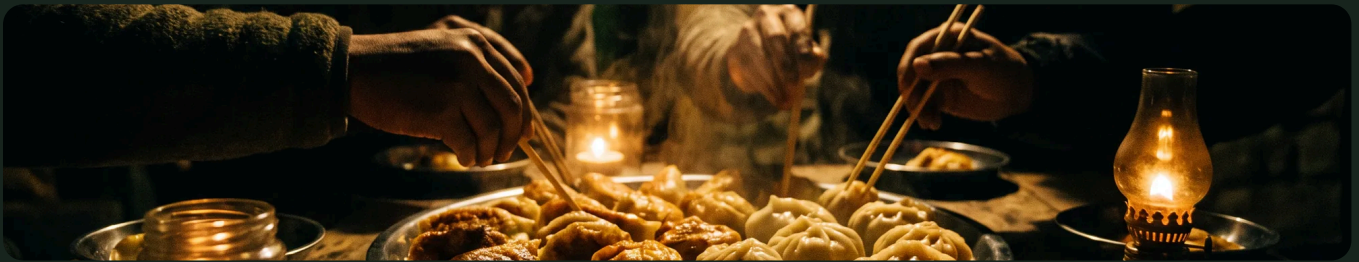
```
ffmpeg -i film.mp4 -vframes 1 \  
film-poster.webp
```

07 THREE CSS RULES THAT PREVENT 90% OF SCROLL BUGS

```
html, body { overflow-x: clip; } /* never overflow-x: hidden */  
html:not(.lenis) { scroll-behavior: smooth; }  
/* never overflow:hidden on a section that contains a pinned child */
```

Your launch checklist

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Filled in the concept formula on paper | ☐ Wrote the full shot list first |
| ☐ Generated the 6 story images in order, chaining references | ☐ Generated plates, cutouts, atmosphere photos, garnishes |
| ☐ Verified every cutout on a solid colour | ☐ Generated, merged and re-encoded the hero film (-g 1) |
| ☐ Compressed ambient films and extracted poster frames | ☐ Set up the project folder with dev-server.mjs |
| ☐ Confirmed the AI tool can see /assets | ☐ Sent the filled-in master prompt |
| ☐ Iterated with specific, one-at-a-time feedback | ☐ Checked the brand name isn't already in use |
| ☐ Removed raw source files before deploying | ☐ Deployed to Netlify or Vercel |



— ◆ —

*Swap the product, the story and the palette
— the same pipeline builds the next one.*

AUTOMATIONX

Built by **Dhiraj Sarkar** · SlangAI · AutomationX

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